

DATA IN EVERYDAY LIFE

a handbook



Navigating a Data-Driven World



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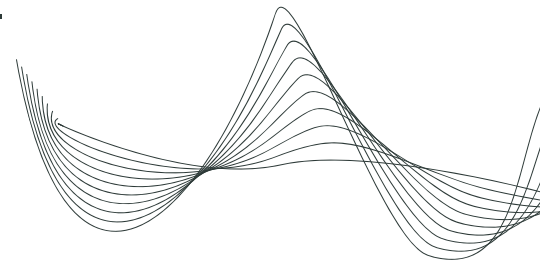


Introduction



We live in a world shaped by data. From the recommendations on your streaming service, to the graphs in your lecture slides, to the fitness stats on your phone - data is embedded in nearly every part of modern life. Yet for many university students, it can feel intimidating or abstract. Data literacy, the ability to read, interpret and communicate data, is one of the most transferable skills you can develop at university, and one that employers across every industry are actively looking for. This handbook offers a practical starting point.

Inside, you will find:



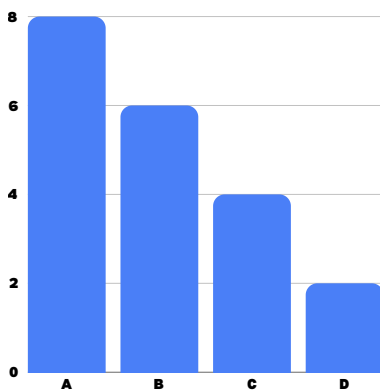
- **Data Visuals** - an introduction to the most common chart types you will encounter in research, media and everyday life
- **Real Applications** - where data already shows up in your daily routine, often without you realising it
- **Tools & Skills** - a practical overview of the tools used to work with and communicate data

Data Visuals

Different types of data visuals

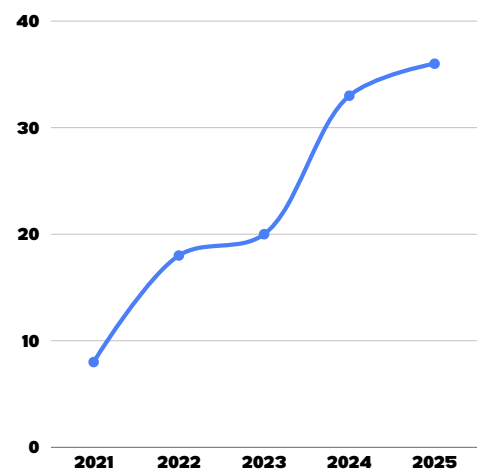
Data visualisation is the practice of representing information graphically – turning numbers and figures into charts and diagrams that make patterns, trends and relationships easier to see and understand. Being able to read and interpret these visuals makes it easier to make informed decisions, spot misleading information and engage confidently with the world around you. Knowing which visual to use, and how to read it, is a foundational skill for anyone navigating modern life.

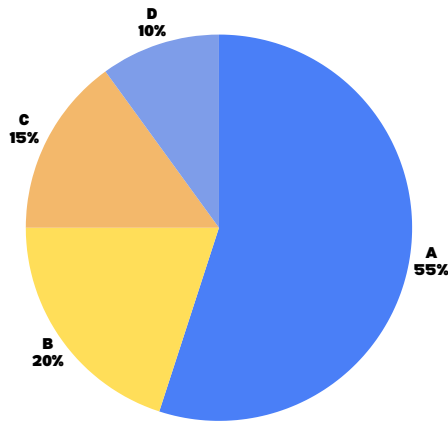
Below are the most common chart types you will encounter.



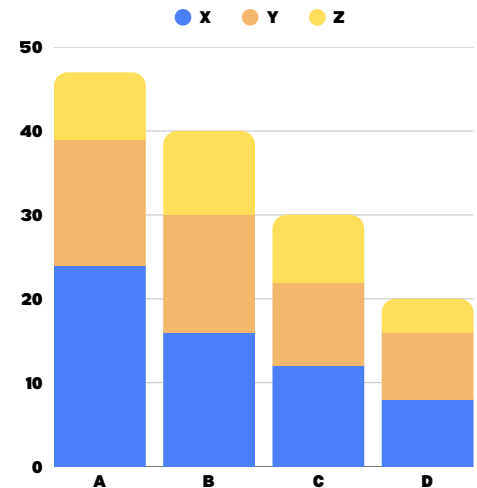
Bar Chart uses rectangular bars to compare values across different categories. The taller the bar, the greater the value.

Line Graph uses connected points to show how a value changes over time. Ideal for spotting trends and patterns.

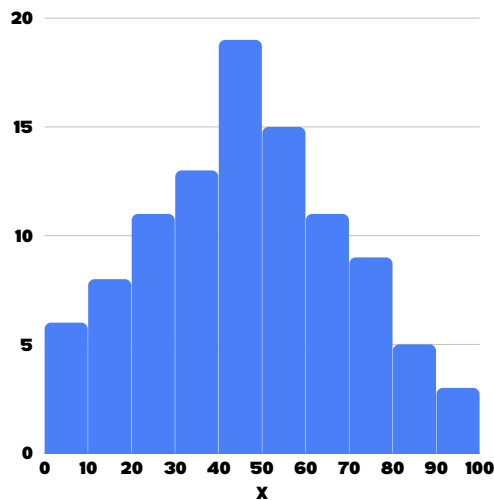




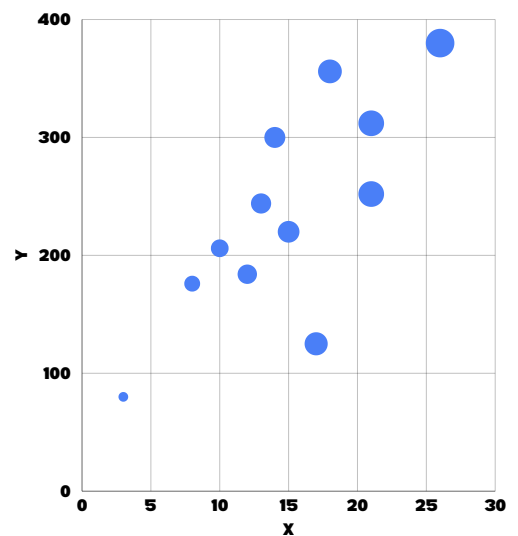
Pie Chart uses slices to show how a whole is divided into parts. Best used when comparing proportions.



Stacked Bar Chart uses layered bars to show how different parts contribute to a whole across multiple categories.



Histogram looks similar to a bar chart but shows how frequently values fall within a range. Used to display distribution.



Scatter Plot plots individual data points on two axes to reveal whether a relationship exists between two variables.

A simple guide to reading graphs/charts

Title

tells you what the chart is about. Always read this first as it frames everything you are about to see.

Axes

the horizontal axis (x) typically shows categories or time, while the vertical axis (y) shows values or quantities. Check what each axis represents before drawing any conclusions.

Scale

look at the numbers on the axes. A scale that does not start at zero can make differences appear larger than they actually are.

Legend

explains what colours, lines or patterns represent. Essential when a chart contains more than one variable.

Labels

identify specific data points, categories or units of measurement. They tell you exactly what you are looking at.

Source

indicates where the data came from. Always check this to assess the credibility and context of the information being presented.

Real Applications

Investing for the Future



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Investing for the Future



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Real Applications



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Tools and Skills

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Tools and Skills

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Conclusion



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